OCTOBER 2024 - VOL. 34

BIONIC BEATS!

A Monthly Publication

(front row left to right) Scott Marsh, Reynaldo Morales, Nicholas Gardner, Lakan Smith, Raymond Conley (back row left to right) Anjali Patel, Bryce Dahl, Alex Wright, Salvador Robles, Mike McDonald, Mike Poynter, and Tony Gutierrez

Bionic Team at AOPA 2024 in Charlotte, NC

In the month of September, several Bionic Team members participated in the annual American Orthotic & Prosthetic Association's Conference in Charlotte, NC. The event was a great opportunity for our clinical team to expand their knowledge and improve their skills. With several days of educational courses, product showcases, and relationship building, our team will be able to continue to provide top notch patient care.

Furthermore, for the first time ever, we had the pleasure of having our very own patients attending an O&P Conference. Reynaldo Morales and Raymond Conley, two of our long

(left to right) Anjali Patel, Mattie McKee, Kayla Watts

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time patients, had the honor to experience the event from a completely different perspective. Both of them are above-knee amputees and had the chance to trial newly released prosthetic knees from BrainRobotics and BionicM.

Morales stated that "The event was a learning experience on so many levels. I have a whole new level of appreciation for the fabrication process, the cutting edge technology and the Bionic Team for making me feel part of their family."

Conley also had positive comments about his experience. "It opened my eyes to what all is out there, especially with regards to highly advanced technology. The Team was also very relatable and had an awesome positive energy."

We would like to give a big shout out to everyone involved in the event, especially to our beloved patients!

(left side front to back) Scott Marsh, Nicholas Gardner, Mohit Srivastava, Sagar Shetty, Raymond Conley, Alex Wright (right side front to back) Tony Gutierrez, Anjali Patel, Lakan Smith, Mike McDonald, Bryce Dahl, and Reynaldo Morales

FABRICATION
Spotlight

Spooktacular Job!

BIONIC NEW HIRES

PAMELA ROBERTS
Clinic Office Administrator
Fort Myers, FL

JAY HOWLAND, CP
Certified Prosthetist
Louisville, KY

FRANK RISKA, CO
Certified Orthotist
Merrillville, IN

BREE BICHEL
Clinic Office Administrator
Appleton, WI

ALYSSA COURSEY
Clinic Office Administrator
Clarksville, TN

NADIA URENO
Clinic Office Administrator
Laredo, TX

Welcome to the Team!

OCTOBER 2024

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
29	30	1	2	3	4	5
6	7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18	19
20	21	22	23	24	25	26
27	28	29	30	31 Happy Halloween!	1	2

Halloween Dinner

SERVINGS: 6
PREP TIME: 15 min.
COOK TIME: 30 min.

Scan for recipe

SERVINGS: 8-10
PREP TIME: 5 min.
COOK TIME: 8-10 min.

Scan for recipe

Ghost S'mores Dip

EMPLOYEE OF THE MONTH:

Arianna Bethea

Boo'rific Job!

"I'm nominating Arianna Bethea for employee of the month. For the past 2 years I've had the pleasure of working with Arianna, I admire her drive to help her patients as well as her practitioners. Arianna is willing to take on additional task and also assist her co-workers in other clinics when asked. Arianna, thank you for your hard work, for jumping in when needed. I am thankful to have you on my team! From myself and the entire NC team we thank you for your dedication and grateful that you have chosen us to be your work family!"

WHY DO WE CELEBRATE HALLOWEEN?

Written by: Don Vaughan, britannica.com

Halloween has been around for more than a thousand years. Originally a religious observance, it became increasingly secular over the centuries until its religious trappings all but disappeared. Today Halloween is considered a holiday for dress-up and fun, especially for children.

Halloween's origins can be traced back to the ancient Celtic festival known as Samhain, which was held on November 1 in contemporary calendars. It was believed that on that day, the souls of the dead returned to their homes, so people dressed in costumes and lit bonfires to ward off spirits. In this way, popular Halloween tropes such as witches, ghosts, and goblins became associated with the holiday.

In the 7th century CE, Pope Boniface IV created All Saints Day, originally celebrated on May 13. A century later, Pope Gregory III moved the holiday to November 1, likely as a Christian substitute for the pagan festival of Samhain. The day before the saintly celebration became known as All Hallows Eve, or Halloween.

Though the holiday began in Celtic regions of Ireland, the United Kingdom, and France, it quickly spread to other parts of the world. The first American colonists in New England were forbidden to celebrate it for religious reasons, though it enjoyed some popularity in the Southern colonies. By the 1800s, fall festivals marking the seasonal harvest incorporated Halloween elements, and Irish immigrants escaping the devastating Potato Famine brought with them many Halloween traditions that remain today.

The custom of trick-or-treating, in which children dress up in costume and solicit treats from neighbors, became popular in the United States in the early 20th century as Irish and Scottish communities revived the Old World custom of "guising," in which a person would dress in costume and tell a joke, recite a poem, or perform some other trick in exchange for a piece of fruit or other treat. By 1950, trick-or-treating for candy had become one of Halloween's most popular activities. Today, Halloween is one of the biggest holidays for candy sales in the United States, estimated to be more than $3 billion, according to the National Retail Federation.

BLAST TO THE PAST!

Spirit Week 2023